

❑ Karmaṇy-evādhikāras Te · Yoga-sthaḥ Kuru Karmāṇi ❑

Bhagavad Gītā · Chapter 2 · Verses 47 & 48 — The heart of Karma-Yoga · Lord Kṛṣṇa to Arjuna

❑ **Why these two verses belong together:** Verse 2.47 tells you *what* to renounce — the fruits of action. Verse 2.48 tells you *how* — by being established in yoga, even-minded toward success and failure. Together they form the Gītā's complete formula for selfless action: *act without claim, with equanimity*. The closing line of 2.48 — “**samatvaṁ yoga ucyate**” — gives the Gītā's most famous definition: “*evenness of mind is yoga*.”

VERSE 2.47 — THE PRINCIPLE

कर्मण्येवाधिकारस्ते मा फलेषु कदाचन ।
मा कर्मफलहेतुर्भूर्मा ते सङ्गोऽस्त्वकर्मणि ॥
కర్మణ్యేవాధికారస్తే మా ఫలేషు కదాచన ।
మా కర్మఫలహేతుర్భూర్మా తే సంగోఽస్త్వకర్మణి ॥

*karmaṇy evādhikāras te mā phaleṣu kadācana
mā karma-phala-hetur bhūr mā te saṅgo'stv akarmaṇi*

“You have the right to action alone — never to its fruits. Let not the fruit be your motive, nor cling to inaction.”

VERSE 2.48 — THE PRACTICE

योगस्थः कुरु कर्माणि सङ्गं त्यक्त्वा धनञ्जय ।
सिद्ध्यसिद्ध्योः समो भूत्वा समत्वं योग उच्यते ॥
యోగస్థః కురు కర్మాణి సంగం త్యక్త్వా ధనంజయ ।
సిద్ధ్యసిద్ధ్యోః సమో భూత్వా సమత్వం యోగ ఉచ్యతే ॥
*yoga-sthaḥ kuru karmāṇi saṅgaṁ tyaktvā dhananjaya
siddhy-asiddhyoḥ samo bhūtvā samatvaṁ yoga ucyate*
“Established in yoga, perform actions abandoning attachment, even-minded in success and failure — such equanimity is called yoga.”

✦ Word-by-Word — 2.47

IAST · संस्कृतम् · Devanagari	PRON.		MEANING
<i>karmaṇi</i>	कर्मणि	కర్మణి	KAR-ma-ni — in (your) action / duty
<i>eva</i>	एव	ఏవ	E-va — only, certainly
<i>adhikāraḥ</i>	अधिकारः	అధికారః	a-dhi-KAA-rah — the right, entitlement
<i>te</i>	ते	తే	te — yours
<i>mā</i>	मा	మా	maa — never (prohibitive)
<i>phaleṣu</i>	फलेषु	ఫలేషు	pha-LE-shu — in the fruits / results
<i>kadācana</i>	कदाचन	కదాచన	ka-DAA-cha-na — at any time, ever
<i>mā</i>	मा	మా	maa — let it not be
<i>karma-phala</i>	कर्मफल	కర్మఫల	KAR-ma-PHA-la — fruit of action
<i>hetuḥ</i>	हेतुः	హేతుః	HE-tuh — cause, motive
<i>bhūḥ</i>	भूः	భూః	bhooḥ — be (imperative — “do not be”)
<i>mā · te</i>	मा · ते	మా · తే	maa · te — nor · for you
<i>saṅgaḥ</i>	सङ्गः	సంగః	SAN-gah — attachment, clinging
<i>astu</i>	अस्तु	అస్తు	AS-tu — let it be
<i>akarmaṇi</i>	अकर्मणि	అకర్మణి	a-KAR-ma-ni — in inaction

1❑ Right to Action

You may act — that is your domain.

2❑ Not to Fruits

Results are not yours to claim.

3❑ Equanimity in Both

Same in success or failure.

4❑ This = Yoga

That evenness is Yoga itself.

❑ **Combined teaching:** “*Act fully — that is your right. But surrender the fruit. Stay rooted in yoga, abandon attachment, and remain even-minded whether you succeed or fail. Such evenness of mind is what we call Yoga.*” Together, 2.47 and 2.48 are the foundation of **Niṣkāma Karma-Yoga** — the path of selfless action. 2.47 prescribes the *renunciation*; 2.48 prescribes the *state of being* that makes such renunciation possible. Without 2.48, 2.47 sounds like duty without joy; with 2.48, it becomes a complete spiritual technology.

✦ Word-by-Word — 2.48

IAST · संस्कृतम् · Devanagari	PRON.		MEANING
<i>yoga-sthaḥ</i>	योगस्थः	యోగస్థః	YO-ga-sthaḥ — established / steadfast in yoga
<i>kuru</i>	कुरु	కురు	KU-ru — perform, do (imperative)
<i>karmāṇi</i>	कर्माणि	కర్మాణి	kar-MAA-ni — actions, duties (plural)
<i>saṅgam</i>	सङ्गम्	సంగమ్	SAN-gam — attachment
<i>tyaktvā</i>	त्यक्त्वा	త్యక్త్వా	tyak-TVAA — having abandoned, giving up
<i>dhananjaya</i>	धनञ्जय	ధనంజయ	dha-NAN-ja-ya — O Arjuna (“winner of wealth”)
<i>siddhi-asiddhyoḥ</i>	सिद्ध्यसिद्ध्योः	సిద్ధ్యసిద్ధ్యోః	sid-dhya-sid-DHYOH — in success & failure
<i>samaḥ</i>	समः	సమః	SA-mah — equal, even, the same
<i>bhūtvā</i>	भूत्वा	భూత్వా	bhoo-TVAA — having become
<i>samatvam</i>	समत्वम्	సమత్వమ్	sa-mat-VAM — equanimity, evenness
<i>yogaḥ</i>	योगः	యోగః	YO-gah — yoga (union, disciplined skill)
<i>ucyate</i>	उच्यते	ఉచ్యతే	uch-YA-te — is called, is said to be
★ <i>samatvaṁ yoga ucyate</i> — “Equanimity itself is called Yoga.” One of the Gītā's three classical definitions of yoga.			

संस्कृतम्

Devanagari

IAST Sanskrit

Pronunciation

English Meaning

❑ Bhagavad Gītā 2.47 – 2.48 · The Heart of Karma-Yoga